

# 2026 Is Already Decided

## Educational Workbook & Personal Reflection Guide

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**IMPORTANT:** This workbook is for educational purposes only. Nothing contained here is financial advice or a recommendation to buy or sell any investment. All investing involves risk, including potential loss of principal. Please consult with a qualified financial advisor before making any investment decisions.

**Welcome!** This workbook is designed to help you think critically about the six major economic trends happening in 2026 and how they might affect your financial situation.

As you work through this guide, remember: knowledge is power, but only when you apply it. Take time to answer each question honestly. There are no right or wrong answers—this is about *your* situation and *your* goals.

### How to Use This Workbook:

- Read each trend summary carefully
- Think about how it applies to your personal situation
- Write your answers in the spaces provided
- Come back to this workbook as 2026 unfolds

## The 6 Trends That Will Shape 2026

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### TREND #1: The \$4.7 Trillion Flood

Nearly \$5 trillion is about to flood into the US economy in just 9 months. This comes from tax refunds (average \$8,500 per household), corporations bringing money back from overseas, and businesses making big equipment purchases.

#### Key Facts:

- Tax refunds start in February 2026

- \$2.1 trillion in corporate money coming back from overseas
- This much money entering the economy could cause prices to rise (inflation)

**REFLECTION QUESTION:**

If you receive a tax refund this year, what will you do with it? How much will go to debt, savings, or investments?

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**TREND #2: Tax Cuts & Changes**

Major changes to the tax code are now in effect. Some are permanent, others are temporary (2025-2028). These include no tax on tips (up to \$25,000), no tax on overtime pay, car loan interest deductions, and bigger deductions for seniors.

**Key Facts:**

- Standard deduction: \$16,100 (single) or \$32,200 (married)
- Estate tax exclusion: \$15 million per person
- Some benefits are temporary—they expire after 2028

**REFLECTION QUESTION:**

Which tax changes affect you personally? Should you adjust your tax planning strategy?

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### **TREND #3: Critical Minerals & Supply Chains**

The US is highly dependent on other countries (especially China) for minerals needed in smartphones, electric vehicles, military equipment, and technology. The government is now investing to produce these materials domestically.

#### **Key Facts:**

- USA is 100% dependent on imports for 12 critical minerals
- China controls 90% of rare earth processing
- Nearly \$1 billion in government funding for domestic production

#### **REFLECTION QUESTION:**

Do you own any investments in mining, materials, or domestic manufacturing? Should you research companies in this space?

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### **TREND #4: AI Spending Explosion (\$2.5 Trillion)**

Artificial Intelligence spending will hit \$2.5 trillion globally in 2026—a 44% increase from 2025. Big tech companies like Google, Meta, Microsoft, and Amazon will spend up to \$700 billion just on AI infrastructure.

#### **Key Facts:**

- AI chip spending: \$268 billion
- 35% of large companies are adopting AI
- 8% of current jobs may be affected by AI
- For the first time, more money is being spent using AI than training it

#### **REFLECTION QUESTION:**

How might AI affect your job or industry? Are you learning to use AI tools to stay competitive?

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### **TREND #5: Defense Spending (\$1+ Trillion)**

The proposed defense budget for 2026 is over \$1 trillion—with plans to increase to \$1.5 trillion by 2027. This money will go to missile defense, drones, AI systems, space programs, and advanced weapons technology.

#### **Key Facts:**

- \$25 billion for missile defense systems
- \$40 billion for Space Force (30% increase)
- Every military squad will get drone technology
- Defense contractors have guaranteed multi-year contracts

### **REFLECTION QUESTION:**

Do you have any exposure to defense or aerospace companies in your portfolio? Is this a sector you want to research?

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## TREND #6: Interest Rate Uncertainty

The Federal Reserve's interest rate decisions will significantly impact your investments and savings in 2026. There's political pressure for rate cuts, but inflation concerns remain. The Fed Chair position changes in May 2026.

### Key Facts:

- Fed projects 1 rate cut; markets expect 2 cuts
- New Fed Chair appointed in May 2026
- Inflation is still above the 2% target
- Rate decisions affect everything: stocks, real estate, savings accounts

### REFLECTION QUESTION:

How would your finances be affected if interest rates go down? What about if they stay high or go up?

## Connecting the Dots: What This Means for You

All six trends point to one major theme: **more money entering the economy**. When this happens, the value of cash often decreases over time due to inflation. Here's what experts suggest you consider:

### KEY QUESTION: What percentage of your money is sitting in cash?

**Do you have an inflation protection strategy? (Examples: real assets, companies with pricing power, diversified investments)**

**Action Steps to Consider (Check when completed):**

- ☐ Review your current investment portfolio and asset allocation
- ☐ Schedule a meeting with a qualified financial advisor to discuss these trends
- ☐ Research how inflation has historically affected different types of investments
- ☐ Evaluate your emergency fund (experts recommend 3-6 months of expenses)
- ☐ Learn about sectors mentioned in the video (tech, defense, materials, etc.)
- ☐ Determine your risk tolerance and investment time horizon

## Your Personal Investment Education Plan

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**What is your biggest takeaway from these 6 trends?**

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**What's one area you want to learn more about?**

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**What specific action will you take in the next 30 days?**

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## Ready to Take Your Investment Education Further?

You're tired of watching your money sit idle while inflation eats away at your purchasing power, aren't you? While others struggle with investment decisions, educated investors are building their knowledge with research-backed strategies. Felix & Friends provides educational resources and research to help inform your investment decisions.

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Keep this workbook and revisit it throughout 2026 to track your progress and insights.